

F1 Histories of making — Pass 2, v1

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The workflow as run, and the verdict

Your sequence is better at the front (benchmark and critique before redesign) and the Module Factory is better at the back (specs, engines, copy, prototypes, checks in a fixed order), so the merged workflow v2 below is what this document follows and what every later module will run.

Step	Your sequence	Module Factory (v3.0)	Verdict
Study and benchmark comparable treatments of the subject	First	Absent	Adopt; the benchmark changes the design (see §2)
Research, uncapped and logged	Second	First	Same step; keep the log format
Evaluate the existing structure	Third	Absent as a step	Adopt; the factory assumed the structure was right
Expert round critique	After improvement	Absent	Adopt, but before redesign, not after: critique of the old version is what the redesign answers
Improve and redesign, versioned	Fourth	Second (structure update)	Same step
Unit specs with opening moves, forms, lanes, partner	—	Third	Keep
World set and engine layers	—	Fourth	Keep

Step	Your sequence	Module Factory (v3.0)	Verdict
Copy, prototypes, partner prompts, checks, review, test	—	Fifth to ninth	Keep, unchanged

Workflow v2 (full mode, run on the first module of each level; light mode, steps 1 and 4 shortened, for the rest)

1. Study and benchmark
2. Research sprint, uncapped, logged
3. Evaluate the structure as written
4. Expert round critique
5. Redesign, versioned
6. Unit specs
7. World set and engine layers
8. Copy in the program voice
9. Prototypes
10. Partner prompts
11. Checks: accessibility, claims, licences
12. Your review
13. Test with people

This document covers steps 1–7 for F1 and specifies one unit fully as the exemplar for step 6; steps 8–13 follow once you have reviewed it.

Benchmarks

The strongest models for a global, object-based history module already exist in open form; F1 should borrow Smarthistory's object-first conversational essay, Margolin's chronology-with-geography-and-themes, the Design History Reader's section logic, and the 100-objects format's discipline of one object per idea, and add what none of them has: the maker's and briefer's Apply step and the Atlas.

Benchmark	What it does	What F1 takes	What F1 must do differently
Smarthistory	<cite index="21-1">A leading open educational resource with thousands of free videos and essays by experts, designed for schools, museums and home use, under a CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 licence</cite>; <cite index="26-1">launched Reframing Art History in 2022, a free online art history textbook by leading scholars</cite>	Object-first, conversational essays; two voices in dialogue in front of the object; a global reframed textbook as a model for our own reader	The NC licence means we link to it and learn from its form but cannot reuse its text or video inside a program that sells anything; and Smarthistory is art-first, ours is making-first (tools, textiles, vessels, buildings, dress, interfaces)
Margolin, World History of Design	<cite index="32-1">Progresses chronologically but is divided into chapters by geography, covering all parts of the globe, with special chapters on phenomena such as the age of exhibitions and colonialism</cite>; <cite index="34-1">begins with pre-human toolmaking and rock art so that design is seen as part of an evolutionary process with deep roots</cite>	The three-way structure: time, place, and cross-cutting themes (exhibitions, colonialism, war); the deep start	Not free; we cannot summarise it in a way that replaces it; our own reader must be written from open sources with Margolin as grounding only

Benchmark	What it does	What F1 takes	What F1 must do differently
The Design History Reader, 2nd edition	<cite index="37-1">Covers the international history of design from the 17th century, with primary texts by theorists, designers and reformers and secondary texts, addressing decolonisation, sustainability, historiography, gender and globalisation</cite>, with sections on modes of production and on local, regional, national and global decolonising	Section logic: modes of production, gender, historiography, decolonising as named strands, not footnotes	Ours must start before the 17th century and outside Europe
The decolonial critique itself	Ansari's keynote <cite index="30-1">holds the decolonial turn up to critical appraisal, pointing to co-optation and a lack of nuance, and to the failure to distinguish liberal pluralism and cosmopolitanism from decolonisation and pluriversality</cite>; he warns of <cite index="30-1">foreign practices displacing local ones and the unquestioned adoption of American and European readings in places like Pakistan and India</cite>	A warning built into F1: adding regions to a Western timeline is pluralism, not decolonisation; the module must let other frames set the timeline	This is the hardest design problem in F1 and the reason the pivots are rebuilt as recurrences (§4, §5)

Benchmark	What it does	What F1 takes	What F1 must do differently
Glocal graphic design history in Arab institutions	A study found <cite index="31-1">most graphic design history courses in Arab institutions predominantly focus on Eurocentric content and methodologies</cite> and recommends <cite index="31-1">linking local histories with global narratives</cite>	Evidence that the regional slot is needed and that the regional vertical has a market	The slot must be authored by local voices when it is built
A History of the World in 100 Objects (BBC and British Museum)	One object, one idea, fifteen minutes; the object is the argument	The discipline of one object per unit idea; audio-first narration as a consumption form	British Museum images are not open; our objects come from CC0 collections
Open textbooks in African and world art (for example The Bright Continent) and Open Arts Objects films	Regional open textbooks and short object films exist under CC licences	Models for the regional readers; a check that open regional scholarship exists to cite	Licences are mostly NC; cite and link, do not reuse

What no benchmark does. None teaches a reader to use history in a brief, an attribution line or a consultation; none has a stranger test; none puts the learner's own lineage on the same map as the canon. Those are F1's additions.

Research log v1

Research is open; this first sprint found the frames, the open sources and the licence problems, and produced six findings that change the module's structure.

Open questions (carried into sprint 2)

1. Which independent inventions of writing, urbanism, metallurgy, weaving and the wheel are securely dated enough to show as recurrences on the Atlas, and from which open sources?
2. Which CC0 collections hold objects for each unit at item level, and which units have no CC0 coverage (early Africa and Oceania are the likely gaps)?
3. What do Indigenous data and cultural protocols (the CARE principles, Traditional Knowledge labels, the 2003 UNESCO convention on intangible heritage) require of a consultation protocol, and which of them can be adopted verbatim? To verify.
4. Which public-domain primary texts exist per pivot, beyond the European canon (translations of Ibn Khaldun, the Yingzao Fashi, the Vastu texts, Arabic craft treatises)? To verify translation copyright.
5. Whether Smarthistory's NC licence blocks any use, or only reuse inside paid slices.
6. Which public-domain audio exists for the sound and performance strand of F1.3a.

Sources found in sprint 1

Source	Type	Licence	Grade	Use
Smarthistory, including Reframing Art History	Essays, videos, open textbook	CC BY-NC-SA 4.0	A for form and scholarship	Model; link; do not reuse in paid slices
Margolin, World History of Design (2015)	Two-volume survey	Copyright	A	Grounding for structure; never summarised for learners
The Design History Reader, 2nd ed. (2025)	Primary and secondary texts	Copyright	A	Grounding; its primary texts checked one by one for public-domain status
Ansari, Decolonisation, the History of Design, and the Designs of History	Keynote, open on ResearchGate	Author-shared	A	The warning built into F1.3 and the pivots redesign

Source	Type	Licence	Grade	Use
Towards a Glocal Teaching of the History of Graphic Design	Article	Author-shared	B	Evidence for the regional slot
Metropolitan Museum, Smithsonian, Cleveland, Art Institute of Chicago, Rijksmuseum, National Gallery of Art open access	Collections with APIs	CC0	A	The world set; item-level licence still checked
Archnet	Islamic architecture archive	Varies by item	A	F1.8 and the Islamic-world network chapter
Owen Jones, The Grammar of Ornament (1856)	Plates	Public domain	A	F1.12 and the world's-fair case; also the case for taxonomy as appropriation
Project Gutenberg, Internet Archive, Wikisource	Primary texts	Public domain	A for the texts, B for the translations	Primary-source units; translation dates checked
Our World in Data, UN and World Bank data	Datasets	Open	A	F1.15 and the planetary present
Wikimedia Commons	Images	Item by item	B	Fills gaps; licence per file

Findings that change the structure (applied in §5)

1. A single sequence of pivots is itself a dominant narrative. The pivots become recurrences: things that happened many times in many places (writing, cities, metallurgy, weaving, printing), shown on parallel regional rows with a simultaneity view.

2. Continent chapters reproduce colonial cartography. Regional chapters are kept as worlds of making and joined by network chapters (Indian Ocean, Silk Roads, trans-Saharan, Mediterranean, Atlantic, Pacific), because the exchange of forms lives on the networks.
3. The briefer lane has nothing in F1 about commissioning. A unit on who commissions (patrons, guilds, merchants, industry, agencies, platforms) is the briefer's own history.
4. World's fairs and museums are history-making machines and the source of our own world set. Two units: exhibitions as taxonomy, and the museum as author (collecting, provenance, restitution).
5. Gender, religion and copying are absent as named strands. Three units: textiles and the making that was called women's work; ritual and belief as drivers of making; copying, transfer and counterfeit as the engine of exchange.
6. The Orientation layer cannot be nine pivots in five minutes. Orientation becomes one object read three ways.

Research status. F1: Sprinted (1 of at least 3). Sprint 2 targets questions 1–3; sprint 3 targets item-level world-set verification.

Evaluation and expert round

F1 as written in the register has a good spine (object reading, attribution, obscured labour, the Atlas) and three structural faults: it reproduces the linear timeline it claims to critique, it organises the world by continents, and it gives the briefer nothing to do; the eleven-voice round below finds twenty-six further flaws and gaps.

Evaluation of F1 as written (Master Structure v2.1, 23 units)

Aspect	Judgement
Coverage	Strong on ethics, labour and method; weak on commissioning, institutions, gender, religion, copying; the digital and platform eras compressed into one unit
Structure	Pivots are linear; centres are continental; no network chapters; the Orientation layer is impossible as written

Aspect	Judgement
Depth	23 units in 14 Practice hours is 35 minutes a unit including seven case units; Practice should be 20 hours or the unit count should fall
Lanes	Maker Apply implied; briefer Apply absent from every unit
Making	Almost no K; a module about making with nothing made
Forms	Only the Atlas and three labs; no scrollytelling, object stories or audio assigned
Rights	Assumes open access equals usable; ignores culturally restricted material and NC licences
Test	Object Autopsy on an unseen object is right; it lacks the attribution line and the briefer's sort

Expert round (eleven voices; each names what would go wrong and what is missing)

Voice	Flaws found	Gaps and additions
The historian	Anachronism risk in "pivots"; periodisation borrowed from Europe; dates presented as points when they are ranges	Show dates as ranges with uncertainty; show independent origins as recurrences; add a unit on how periods get named
The decolonial scholar	Adding regions to the Western line is pluralism, not decolonisation; the module could be co-opted as a diversity tour	Let other frames set the timeline (lunar, dynastic, seasonal, genealogical calendars in the Atlas); name who authored each unit; keep the regional slot for local authorship; add a unit on the museum as author
The museum educator	Reading before looking; too many objects per unit; no slow looking	Object-first openings; three objects per unit maximum at Practice; a slow-looking protocol in F1.17

Voice	Flaws found	Gaps and additions
The learning designer	Cognitive overload at 23 units; no retrieval practice; the Orientation layer overloaded	Fewer, longer units; a spaced recall deck of objects; Orientation as one object read three ways
The briefer	Nothing to take into a meeting	The commissioning history unit; a reference note and an attribution line as the briefer's Apply; the sort as the closing test
The maker	History with no hands	Making-first openings in three units: a paper loom or strip weave, a stamp or seal, a paper-fold module; the Object Autopsy on the learner's own possession
The rights lawyer	CC0 is not the same as culturally usable; Smarthistory and most open textbooks are NC; translations of public-domain texts may be in copyright	A sensitivity flag in the world set; exclusion of ancestral, sacred and funerary material unless the source community has published it for use; NC content linked, never reused; translation dates checked
The engineer	The Atlas is specified as an engine before there is content; 1,200 records is a data-entry project; museum APIs have rate limits and changing terms	Atlas v1 as static JSON and SVG with 60 objects; a record schema now; API terms recorded per collection
The regional scholar	The Gulf slot is one unit at the end; the Islamic world is treated as a region, not a network	The Islamic world as the model network chapter; the regional slot built with local authors; pearling, dhow building, sadu and gypsum carving as future cases
The planet	Materials history is extraction history and the module does not say so	A thread checkpoint: every object story names where the material came from and what it cost the place

Voice	Flaws found	Gaps and additions
The accessibility reviewer	An image-heavy module with no alt text policy; timelines that depend on colour	Alt text and audio description for every object; colour-independent Atlas layers; audio companions for the narrative units

Flaws that would only appear later. The world set's regional balance will skew to what CC0 collections hold (Europe, East Asia, the Islamic world, the Americas well; Africa and Oceania poorly), which would quietly reproduce the bias the module critiques; the mitigation is to track coverage per region and to fill gaps with Wikimedia and community-published material, with the gap itself taught in F1.3.

F1 v3.3 redesign

Thirty-one units: two at Orientation, twenty-four at Practice, five at Mastery; about 4 / 20 / 18 hours; the pivots become recurrences, the continents become worlds joined by networks, and every unit now has an opening move, assigned forms, an Apply for each lane and a partner voice. F1 is renumbered because it is the first module through the factory; the Was column maps every old number.

Forms are numbered as in Final Structure §Presentation forms (1 scrollytelling, 2 step-through, 3 object story, 4 explorable, 5 before/after, 7 video, 8 audio, 10 comparison wall, 11 timeline scrub, 12 map, 13 argument card, 14 sequential illustration, 15 prediction prompt). Apply: M = maker, B = briefer.

Unit	Concept	Depth	Field	Opening · forms	Apply (M / B)	Voice · media	Was
F1.1	One object, three readings: material, labour, meaning	O	SRC	Object first · 3	M: read an object you own / B: write its attribution line	Historian · img	new
F1.2	The reference-to-appropriation spectrum	O	SRC	Prediction first · 15, 3	Both: sort six cases; B: flag the one you would stop in a brief	Historian · img	F1.2

Unit	Concept	Depth	Field	Opening · forms	Apply (M / B)	Voice · media	Was
F1.3	How histories get written: canons, periods, the timeline as an argument	P	SRC	Argument first · 13, 11	Both: annotate one canonical timeline for what it excludes	Mirror · ani	F1.3
F1.4	Interdisciplinary discourse: what film, performance, sound, gaming and digital culture teach making	P	SRC, GRM.n	Story first · 10, 7	Both: extract one method from a non-design discipline for your world	Mirror · vid, aud	F1.3a
F1.5	Recurrences: writing, cities, metallurgy, weaving and printing happened many times in many places	P	SRC	Data first · 1, 11 (Atlas simultaneity view)	Both: place three objects on parallel regional rows and date them as ranges	Historian · img, dat	F1.1
F1.6	Worlds of making: Africa	P	SRC	Object first · 3, 10	M: a reference note / B: a reference note with a consultation flag	Historian · img	F1.4
F1.7	Worlds of making: the Americas	P	SRC	Object first · 3, 10	same	Historian · img	F1.5
F1.8	Worlds of making: East Asia	P	SRC	Object first · 3, 10	same	Historian · img	F1.6
F1.9	Worlds of making: South and Southeast Asia	P	SRC	Object first · 3, 10	same	Historian · img	F1.7
F1.10	The Islamic world as a network: a world made of routes	P	SRC	Data first · 12, 3	same, plus: name a route your world could use	Historian · img, drw (Archnet)	F1.8
F1.11	Europe as one world among several	P	SRC	Object first · 3, 10	same	Historian · img	F1.9
F1.12	Worlds of making: Oceania and the Pacific	P	SRC	Object first · 3, 10	same, with the sensitivity flag explained	Historian · img	F1.10

Unit	Concept	Depth	Field	Opening · forms	Apply (M / B)	Voice · media	Was
F1.13	Networks: Silk Roads, Indian Ocean, trans-Saharan, Mediterranean, Atlantic, Pacific	P	SRC	Data first · 12, 1	Both: trace one object's route end to end	Historian · dat, img	F1.11
F1.14	Copying, transfer and counterfeit: porcelain, chintz, lacquer, print	P	SRC, RGT	Object first · 5, 3	M: find the copy in your own references / B: what a licensing clause would have said (to R2)	Historian · img	new
F1.15	Ornament as a global language; the exhibition as taxonomy (1851 and the Grammar of Ornament)	P	GRM.f, SRC	Prediction first (guess the region of a pattern) · 3, 10	Both: run the Pattern Comparer; B: name what was extracted and from whom	Historian · public-domain plates	F1.12
F1.16	Ritual and belief as drivers of making	P	GRM.n, SRC	Object first · 3, 8	Both: name the ritual your world serves	Historian · img, aud	new
F1.17	Who commissions: patrons, guilds, merchants, industry, agencies, platforms	P	SRC, CMB	Argument first · 2, 13	M: place your work in the commissioning chain / B: write the brief a patron would have given	Client · ani	new
F1.18	Textiles and the making that was called women's work	P	SRC, GRM.m	Making first (a paper strip weave) · 3, 7	Both: write a credit line for a textile	Historian · img	new
F1.19	Industry, the machine and the exhibition	P	SRC	Story first · 1, 3	Both: what the machine changed in your medium	Fabricator · img	F1.13
F1.20	Modernisms, plural	P	SRC	Object first (three modernisms side by side) · 10, 13	Both: which modernism your world descends from, and which it refuses	Historian · img	F1.14

Unit	Concept	Depth	Field	Opening · forms	Apply (M / B)	Voice · media	Was
F1.21	Consumer society, the digital and the platform	P	SRC	Story first · 1, 7	Both: the platform your world lives on	Client · img, vid	F1.15
F1.22	The planetary present: making as extraction	P	SRC, PLW	Data first · 12, 4	Both: the material chain of one object you own	Planet · dat	F1.15
F1.23	Obscured labour: the credit map	P	SRC	Object first · 3	Both: credit map of your own project	Historian · img	F1.16
F1.24	The museum as author: collecting, provenance, restitution	P	SRC	Argument first · 13, 3	M: provenance chain of one world-set object / B: what to ask a museum partner	Historian · img	new
F1.25	Reading an object as history: slow looking and the autopsy	P	SRC	Lab first · Object Autopsy, full	Both: a full autopsy	Mirror · img	F1.17
F1.26	Attribution and consultation as protocol	P	SRC	Problem first (a brief that references a tradition) · 2, 15	Both: draft the protocol; B: apply it to a real brief	Historian · template	F1.18
F1.27	Counter-history research piece on one lineage	M	SRC, DOS	Artifact first · Atlas authoring	Both: the piece, with an attribution record	Historian · learner's material	F1.19
F1.28	Primary sources and archives: how to read them	M	SRC	Problem first · Source Grader, archive walkthroughs	Both: five sources graded, one translated text dated	Historian · img	F1.20
F1.29	Vernacular intelligence: oral history, folktale and local taxonomy, with consent	M	SRC	Making first (record a maker or elder) · Oral History Kit	Both: one recorded, transcribed, consented account	Historian · aud	F1.20a
F1.30	Re-timing the Atlas: other calendars and periodisations	M	SRC	Data first · Atlas calendar layer	Both: your lineage on a non-Gregorian timeline	Historian · dat	new

Unit	Concept	Depth	Field	Opening · forms	Apply (M / B)	Voice · media	Was
F1.31	Regional slot: the learner's own place on the map	M	SRC	Artifact first · Atlas regional layer	Both: the slot filled	Historian · learner's material	F1.21

Closing test. Maker: an Object Autopsy on an unseen object, with an attribution line and the material's origin named. Briefer: a sort of eight cases on the spectrum with reasons, plus the consultation flag on the ones that need it. Both: one line added to the artifact's sources record.

What changed and why (versioned as structure v3.3 in the Master Structure): pivots to recurrences (finding 1); worlds and networks (finding 2); commissioning unit (finding 3); exhibitions and the museum as author (finding 4); textiles, ritual and copying (finding 5); Orientation as one object (finding 6); making-first openings in F1.18 and F1.29 (the maker's critique); the calendar unit (the decolonial critique); Practice hours from 14 to 20 (the learning designer's critique).

World set v1 and the Timeline Atlas

The world set for F1 targets 60 verified objects for the Atlas v1 and about 90 for the unit cases, all from CC0 collections at item level; the candidates below are object types with target collections, to be verified item by item in sprint 3, and the Atlas starts as a static layered timeline of those 60, not as an engine.

World set candidates by unit (type · target collection · caution)

Unit	Candidates
F1.1, F1.25	The learner's own object; a spare set of five everyday objects from Cooper Hewitt or Smithsonian NMAH (CC0)

Unit	Candidates
F1.5 Recurrences	Cuneiform tablets (Met) · oracle bone or early bronze inscription (Met, Cleveland) · Maya glyph object (Cleveland, AIC; codices are facsimiles) · Indus seal (Met, to verify) · Egyptian papyrus (Met) · early metallurgy: Anatolian, Andean, West African bronze (Met, Cleveland, Smithsonian NMAfA) · loom weights and early textiles (Met) · movable type and block prints: Chinese, Korean, European (Met, Rijksmuseum)
F1.6 Africa	Benin plaques and heads (Met, Cleveland; provenance taught in F1.24) · Kente and Ewe strip cloth (Smithsonian NMAfA) · Nok terracotta (Met, to verify) · Ethiopian manuscripts (Met) · Kuba textiles (Cleveland) · Yoruba beadwork (Met) · Great Zimbabwe photographs (Wikimedia)
F1.7 The Americas	Paracas and Nasca textiles (Met, Cleveland) · khipu (Met; AMNH is not CC0) · Moche vessels (Met) · Olmec, Maya, Aztec stone and ceramics (Met, Cleveland, AIC) · Pueblo and Plains material (Smithsonian NMAI, with sensitivity checks) · Inuit tools (Smithsonian)
F1.8 East Asia	Shang bronzes (Met, Cleveland) · Song ceramics (Met) · Japanese lacquer and prints (Met, AIC) · Korean celadon (Met) · Yingzao Fashi plates (public domain, Wikisource) · mingei objects (Met)
F1.9 South and Southeast Asia	Indus material (Met) · Chola bronzes (Met, Cleveland) · Mughal textiles and manuscripts (Met) · Kashmir shawls (Met) · Indonesian batik and ikat (Met, Cleveland) · Khmer sculpture (Met)
F1.10 The Islamic world	Astrolabes (Met) · Iznik ceramics (Met) · Mamluk metalwork and glass (Met) · Qur'an folios (Met) · Nasrid and Mughal architecture (Archnet, Wikimedia) · Andalusian textiles (Cleveland)

Unit	Candidates
F1.11 Europe	Medieval tools and manuscripts (Met) · Renaissance workshop objects (Met, NGA) · Delftware (Rijksmuseum) · Wedgwood (Met) · Thonet chair (Met, Cooper Hewitt) · Bauhaus objects (Cooper Hewitt; check rights on 20th-century works)
F1.12 Oceania and the Pacific	Tapa cloth (Met, Smithsonian) · navigation charts (Smithsonian) · Māori and Hawaiian objects (Met, with sensitivity checks and community-published sources preferred) · Papua New Guinea shields (Met)
F1.13 Networks	Sogdian and Silk Road textiles (Cleveland) · Swahili coast objects (Smithsonian NMAfA) · Roman-Indian trade material (Met) · Atlantic trade objects (Smithsonian NMAAHC, with care) · Manila galleon goods (AIC)
F1.14 Copying	Chinese blue-and-white, Iznik, Delft and Meissen side by side (Met, Rijksmuseum) · Indian chintz and European copies (Met) · Japanese export lacquer (Rijksmuseum) · chinoiserie and japonisme (Met, AIC)
F1.15 Ornament and exhibitions	Owen Jones plates (public domain) · Great Exhibition prints and the Crystal Palace (public domain) · colonial exposition posters (public domain by date, check)
F1.16 Ritual	Temple, mosque, church and shrine objects across worlds (Met, Cleveland, Archnet) · calligraphy (Met) · ritual vessels (Met)
F1.17 Commissioning	Guild records and pattern books (public domain) · merchant ledgers (Internet Archive) · early advertising (Smithsonian NMAH, Library of Congress) · a platform interface screenshot (own capture)

Unit	Candidates
F1.18 Textiles	Andean, West African, Coptic, Indian, Central Asian textiles (Met, Cleveland) · Bauhaus weaving (Cooper Hewitt; rights check) · sadu weaving (regional slot, later)
F1.19 Industry	Singer machine (Smithsonian NMAH) · Wedgwood (Met) · Thonet (Met) · Great Exhibition material (public domain)
F1.20 Modernisms	Bauhaus, Constructivist, mingei, Fathy, Mexican and Indian modernisms (Cooper Hewitt, Met, Archnet; posters by date; 20th-century rights checked)
F1.21 Consumer, digital, platform	Post-war appliances and early computers (Smithsonian NMAH, CC0 where marked) · own captures of interfaces
F1.22 Planetary	Material-chain data (Our World in Data) · e-waste and extraction photographs (Wikimedia, CC)
F1.23, F1.24	Objects with documented workshops and provenance chains (Met and Cleveland records carry both)

Coverage tracking. A count per world and per unit, updated every sprint; a unit below three verified objects is flagged; gaps taught in F1.3 as evidence.

Timeline Atlas v1 spec (the engine, built in the order the units need it)

Layer	What it shows	Data needed	Built for	Version
Base	Parallel regional rows on one time axis; objects as points with date ranges and uncertainty	60 records	F1.5	v1, static SVG
Strands	Dominant and obscured strands toggled per object	strand tag per record	F1.3	v1

Layer	What it shows	Data needed	Built for	Version
Routes	Flows between places with dates; an object's route traced	route records (from, to, date range, goods)	F1.10, F1.13, F1.14	v2
Simultaneity	Align a recurrence across rows (all first writing, all first cities)	recurrence tag per record	F1.5	v2
Calendars	Re-time the axis by lunar, dynastic, genealogical or seasonal calendars	calendar mappings	F1.30	v3
Authoring	The learner adds objects and a lineage; export to the artifact	learner records	F1.27, F1.31	v3
Reading mode	Scrub, object story on click, audio	forms 3, 8, 11	every narrative unit	v1

Record schema (one per object): id · title · date range and uncertainty · place (coordinates, modern and historical names) · world · network tags · recurrence tags · materials and their origins · makers and labour (named, unnamed, community) · provenance chain · collection and accession · image URL and licence · sensitivity flag and source-community note · story (150–300 words) · units that use it · alt text and audio description.

Rights, ethics and media plan

F1 is the module most exposed to rights and cultural-sensitivity mistakes, because its material is other people's heritage; five rules govern it and are checked before any unit is Drafted.

Rules

1. Open is not the same as usable. A CC0 image of an ancestral, sacred or funerary object is not used unless the source community has published it for use or the object is widely exhibited by its own institutions; the record carries a sensitivity flag and a note

of the source. The CARE principles and Traditional Knowledge labels are adopted as reference frameworks once verified (research question 3).

2. NC content is linked, never reused. Smarthistory, most open textbooks and many regional films are CC BY-NC; because the Practitioner and Comprehensive slices may be sold, none of their text or video is copied into units. Their form is a model; their pages are links.
3. Public domain applies to the work, not the translation. Translations of primary texts are dated and checked; where no public-domain translation exists, the unit paraphrases and cites.
4. Every object carries a story we wrote. No museum label text is reused beyond the facts; stories are written in the program voice from the record, cited to the collection.
5. Provenance is content. Every world-set record has a provenance chain, and objects with contested provenance (Benin, Maqdala, Pacific material) are taught as such in F1.24 rather than shown without comment.

Media plan for F1

Asset	Count	Source	Notes
Object images	about 150	CC0 collections; Wikimedia for gaps	licence, alt text and audio description per image
Public-domain plates and prints	about 30	Owen Jones, exhibition prints, pattern books	high-resolution scans from Internet Archive or the collections
Scrollytelling pages	5	built: F1.5, F1.13, F1.19, F1.21 and one for F1.15	layers carry time, route and strata
Object stories (deep zoom)	about 90	IIIF where the collection serves it, else static	one story each
Route and map data	6 networks	assembled from open sources, dates as ranges	F1.10, F1.13
Audio	about 25	synthesised narration of argument cards and object stories; public-domain recordings for F1.4 to verify	audio companion for every narrative unit

Asset	Count	Source	Notes
Argument cards	8	F1.3, F1.17, F1.20, F1.24, F1.26 and three more	claim, counter-claim, case
Step-through explainers	3	F1.17 commissioning chain; F1.26 protocol; F1.3 how a canon forms	SVG
Making kits on paper	2	F1.18 strip weave; F1.29 recording guide	printable
Partner prompts	6 voices' packs for F1	Historian leads; Mirror, Client, Fabricator, Planet appear	tested against units before Drafted

Accessibility. Alt text for every image; audio description for the 60 Atlas objects; the Atlas readable without colour (strand by line style, world by row label); every scrollytelling page has a reduced-motion linear version; every unit's Orientation form complete on a phone.

Exemplar unit spec, open questions, next steps

One unit specified to the standard every unit will meet, so you can judge the standard before I write thirty more; then the questions only you can answer.

F1.17 Who commissions: patrons, guilds, merchants, industry, agencies, platforms
(Practice, about 60 minutes)

Element	Content
Essential question	Who has told makers what to make, and how did the brief change hands across history?

Element	Content
Opening move	Argument first: "The designer is a recent invention; for most of history the person who decided what got made was the one paying for it." Counter-claim: "Makers have always shaped the brief from below; guild rules, workshop conventions and material limits decided more than any patron." One case: a Renaissance commissioning contract specifying pigments, sizes and the master's own hand (public-domain text), set beside a modern platform's design guidelines
Lab	Step-through explainer: the commissioning chain across six regimes (patron, guild, merchant, industry, agency, platform); at each step the learner drags who holds the brief, who holds the money, who holds the credit; the explainer shows how the three separate and recombine
Concept	500 words: the brief as a historical object; the rise of the professional designer; what each regime made possible and impossible; the platform as the newest patron
Cases	Three, one object story each: a guild-regulated object with its rules; a merchant-commissioned export ware; a platform-native product with its guideline document. Regional slot: a Gulf pearl-trade commission, later
Apply — maker	Place your own project on the chain: who briefs you, who pays, who is credited; write two sentences on what the regime lets you do and stops you doing; export to the artifact's SRC and CMB fields
Apply — briefer	Write the brief a patron in one of the six regimes would have given for your world's anchor, in that regime's terms (contract, guild rule, purchase order, platform guideline); then rewrite it as your own brief; note what changed

Element	Content
Partner	The Client: "Which regime are you actually in, and which one are you pretending to be in?" ends with a test: give the Stranger your regime's brief and see what it builds
Forms	2 step-through; 13 argument card; 3 object stories; 8 audio of the argument card
Consumption forms	Five-minute: the argument card and the first two steps of the chain · Session: full unit · Reference: the six-regime glossary entry with "say it to a designer"
Media	Three object images (CC0); one public-domain contract text; one platform guideline screenshot (own capture); the explainer's SVG
Artifact fields	SRC (the commissioning history of the learner's medium); CMB (the regime brief)
Threads	Attribution and Authority (who is credited); Writing and Argument (the two sentences)
Closing contribution	One line in the sources record: the regime the learner's world belongs to
Claims sheet	Every dated claim in the concept text with its source; the contract text cited to its public-domain edition

Open questions for you

1. Renumbering: accept that F1 is renumbered with a mapping, or keep old numbers and letter the new units?
2. Hours: Practice at 20 hours (about 50 minutes a unit), or cut back to 18 units and 14 hours?
3. The Islamic world as the model network chapter: agree, or treat it as a world like the others?
4. Sensitivity rule: is rule 1 (exclude sacred, ancestral and funerary material unless community-published) the right line for you, or too cautious?
5. The exemplar unit: is F1.17 at the depth and voice you want for every unit?

Next steps (workflow v2, steps 8–13, after your review)

- Sprint 2 of research: recurrences data, the protocol frameworks, item-level world-set verification for F1.5 and F1.10 first.
- Unit specs for the remaining thirty units at the F1.17 standard, in three batches (Orientation and F1.3–F1.12; F1.13–F1.26; Mastery).
- Atlas v1 as a working page with 60 records.
- Copy for the first batch in the program voice, once the voice guide exists.
- The Master Structure updated to v3.3 with the renumbered F1 and the six findings.